



THE SECRETARY OF THE NAVY
WASHINGTON DC 20350-1000

JAN 30 2026

From: Secretary of the Navy
To: Presidents, FY-27 Navy Reserve Captain Line Promotion Selection Boards

Subj: ORDER CONVENING THE FY-27 PROMOTION SELECTION BOARDS TO CONSIDER OFFICERS IN THE LINE ON THE RESERVE ACTIVE-STATUS LIST OF THE NAVY FOR PERMANENT PROMOTION TO THE GRADE OF CAPTAIN

Ref: (a) FY-27 Active-Duty Navy and Reserve Officer and Chief Warrant Officer Promotion Selection Board Precept

Encl: (1) Board Membership
(2) Recorders and Assistant Recorders
(3) Administrative Support Staff
(4) Statutory and Regulatory Promotion Objectives
(5) Merit Reorder Considerations
(6) USNR LDO Community Value Slides

1. Date and Location

a. The promotion selection boards, consisting of you as presidents, the officers listed in enclosure (1) as members, the officers listed in enclosure (2) as recorders and assistant recorders, and the personnel listed in enclosure (3) as administrative support staff, are ordered to convene at the Navy Personnel Command, Millington, TN, at 0800, February 2, 2026, or as soon as practicable thereafter.

b. The boards shall proceed in accordance with all guidance in this letter, the FY-27 Active-Duty Navy and Reserve Officer and Chief Warrant Officer Promotion Selection Board Precept, reference (a), and (as applicable) the Statutory and Regulatory Promotion Objectives, enclosure (4).

2. Promotion Board Authorized Selections

a. The total number of officers who may be recommended in each competitive category shall be the number that most closely approximates the percentage set forth below of in-zone eligible officers determined as of the date the boards convene. The Chief of Naval Personnel shall determine the number of in-zone and "above-zone, not previously considered" eligible officers on the convening date, calculate the number that may be recommended for promotion under the percentages set forth in the FY-27 Navy

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Reserve Officer Promotion Plan, and furnish the number to the
boards.

b. If the computation results in a fraction of a number of
0.5 or greater, the fraction is rounded up to the nearest whole
number. If the computation results in a fraction of a number
less than 0.5, that fraction is rounded down to the nearest
whole number. The boards may recommend up to the number
provided by the Chief of Naval Personnel.

<u>COMPETITIVE</u> <u>CATEGORY</u>	<u>PERCENT</u> <u>TO SELECT</u>
Unrestricted Line Officer	32
Unrestricted Line Officer (TAR)	50
Special Duty Officer (Human Resources)	20
Special Duty Officer (Human Resources) (TAR)	50
Engineering Duty Officer	73
Aerospace Engineering Duty Officer (Engineering)	50
Aerospace Engineering Duty Officer (Maintenance) (TAR)	50
Special Duty Officer (Public Affairs)	43
Special Duty Officer (Strategic Sealift Officer)	65
Special Duty Officer (Foreign Area)	50
Information Warfare Officer (Oceanography)	33
Information Warfare Officer (Cryptologic Warfare)	50
Information Warfare Officer (Information Professional)	38
Information Warfare Officer (Intelligence)	40
Information Warfare Officer (Maritime Space)	67
Limited Duty Officer (General Line)	50

3. Equal Consideration of Officers "In-Zone" and "Above-Zone".

As detailed above, the number of in-zone and "above-zone, not
previously considered" eligible officers is used only to
calculate the total number of selects authorized. There are no
individual zone selection limitations or expectations.
Accordingly, in determining which officers are best and fully
qualified for promotion, you are required to equally consider
both above-zone and in-zone officers.

4. Consideration of Officers "Below-Zone". The boards shall
identify exceptional officers from below-zone and consider
selecting them for promotion to the grade of captain. The
boards must ensure that these exceptional below-zone candidates
are fully considered for promotion if they meet the best and
fully qualified standard. A number not to exceed 10 percent of

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the total selections authorized for each grade and competitive category may be selected from below-zone unless the number calculated is less than one, in which case the number that may be selected from below-zone is one.

5. Best and Fully Qualified Selection Standard

a. Fully Qualified. All officers recommended for promotion must be fully qualified; that is, each officer recommended must be capable of performing the duties of the next higher pay grade. Officers who do not meet that standard shall not be recommended for promotion. In this era of strategic competition, the Navy needs officers and leaders who are both skilled operators and skilled thinkers who have been exposed to an increasingly complex web of networks, people, and concepts. Our leaders must be evaluated for development of increasing talents in support of operational employment of naval capabilities, understanding of strategic competition, and exposure to the people, concepts, and educational experiences (including technology) to become transformational in the organization.

(1) Officers fully qualified for promotion demonstrate an appropriate level of both **competence**, as evidenced by a commitment to operational excellence and continual performance improvement, and **character**, as evidenced by the presence of the four core attributes of integrity, accountability, initiative, and toughness. Additionally, officers fully qualified for promotion adhere to Navy and Department of War (DoW) ethical standards, are physically fit, and demonstrate loyalty to the Navy Core Values.

(2) Officers fully qualified for promotion should show a readiness for leading and solving problems at larger and larger scales.

(a) Their performance must reflect Navy Core Values: Honor, accountability for behavior, mindful of the privilege to serve our fellow Americans; Courage, the moral and mental strength to do what is right, with confidence and resolution even in the face of temptation or adversity; and Commitment, joining together as a team to improve the quality of our work, our people, and ourselves.

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(b) Upon this foundation of Navy Core Values, they must show a mindset of continuous self-improvement, a desire to "Get Real, Get Better" every day. This includes the ability to: self-assess, to be absolutely honest, humble, and transparent in determining the actual performance of themselves and their teams; self-correct, to apply problem solving frameworks to pursue root cause and solve the Navy's hardest problems in a lasting way; and always learn, to pursue knowledge and apply learning from varied sources in order to make themselves and their teams better.

(c) In modeling this behavior, they must demonstrate an ability to build teams and rapidly collaborate across organizations to solve problems and achieve lasting outcomes. In doing so, they will model the belief that our people and culture are the Navy's asymmetric advantage, showing dignity and respect for everyone, regardless of background or rank. In addition, they will measure themselves by creating opportunities to remove barriers to individual, team, and Navy warfighting excellence.

b. **Best Qualified.** Among the fully qualified officers, you must recommend for promotion the best qualified officers within their respective competitive category. Proven and sustained superior performance in command or other leadership positions in difficult and challenging assignments is a definitive measure of fitness for promotion. Furthermore, contributions to warfighters and warfighting through successful performance and leadership in combat conditions demonstrate exceptional promotion potential and should be given special consideration. Each board member shall apply this guidance when deliberating and voting. Additionally, members will use the considerations below to guide their determination of the best qualified officers.

(1) Command, whether at sea or ashore, is fundamentally about preparing for and leading in combat. You should select those officers who seize absolute ownership of their assigned mission and all that goes into its accomplishment. A command's mission is absolutely essential to the Navy's ability to fight and win. Look for those officers that imbue this belief in their team. Look for those that take fierce pride in this obligation. Select the officers that are the example their team reflects and those that embody humility, selflessness, and complete transparency.

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(2) You must seek those officers that have been relentless in building a culture of the highest character and a tough, resilient team that wins. Our nation needs and expects their Navy to remain above reproach, as a force they admire and rely upon.

(3) Seek those officers that acknowledge the value of every Sailor and civilian. Consider those that take care of themselves and their teammates. Seek those that always do the right thing, especially when it is hard. Consider those that keep close watch on their own mental, physical, and emotional health, and the health of those they lead.

c. **Skill Requirements.** Give due consideration to demonstrated performance and expertise in the competency/skill listed in order of significance below. For amplifying information, refer to the competency/skill information, reference (b) to reference (a).

Unrestricted Line (11X5/13X5):

1. Navy Operational Planner
2. Targeting
3. Unmanned Systems (UxS)
4. Integrated Air and Missile Defense (IAMD)
5. Expeditionary Warfare
6. Joint Experience
7. Cyber Operations and Planning
8. Naval Special Warfare (NSW) Experience
9. Mine Warfare
10. Space Cadre
11. Operations Analysis (OA)
12. Language, Regional Expertise, and Cultural (LREC) Experience

Unrestricted Line (TAR) (11X7/13X7):

1. Financial Management (FM)
2. Shore Installation Leadership
3. Recruiting Leadership
4. Operations Analysis (OA)
5. Requirements Management
6. Navy Operational Planner
7. Naval Special Warfare (NSW) Experience
8. Expeditionary Warfare
9. Integrated Air and Missile Defense (IAMD)
10. Mine Warfare

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11. Space Cadre
12. Unmanned Systems (UxS)

Human Resources (1205):

1. Operations Analysis (OA)
2. Requirements Management
3. Education and Training
4. Financial Management (FM)
5. Joint Experience

Human Resources (TAR) (1207):

1. Operations Analysis (OA)
2. Recruiting Leadership
3. Requirements Management
4. Financial Management (FM)
5. Cyber Operations and Planning

Engineering Duty Officer (14X5):

1. Acquisition Corps
2. Unmanned Systems (UxS)
3. Cyber Operations and Planning
4. Nuclear Weapons (NW) Technical Expertise
5. Integrated Air and Missile Defense (IAMD)
6. Expeditionary Warfare
7. Space Cadre
8. Financial Management (FM)

Aerospace Engineering Duty Officer (Engineering)
(1515):

1. Acquisition Corps
2. Unmanned Systems (UxS)
3. Requirements Management
4. Operations Analysis (OA)
5. Astronaut Consideration

Aerospace Engineering Duty Officer (Maintenance) (TAR)
(1527):

1. Acquisition Corps
2. Education and Training
3. Financial Management (FM)
4. Expeditionary Warfare
5. Operations Analysis (OA)
6. Shore Installation Leadership

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Public Affairs (1655):

1. Joint Experience

Strategic Sealift (1665):

1. Expeditionary Warfare
2. Navy Operational Planner
3. Joint Experience

Foreign Area (1715):

1. Naval Strategist Subspecialty
2. Navy Operational Planner
3. Language, Regional Expertise, and Cultural (LREC)
Experience
4. Joint Experience
5. Attaché Duty

Oceanography (1805):

1. N/A

Cryptologic Warfare (1815):

1. Space Cadre

Information Professional (1825):

1. N/A

Intelligence (1835):

1. N/A

Maritime Space Officer (1875):

1. N/A

Limited Duty Officer (Line) (6XX5):

1. N/A

d. **Additional Considerations.** The following are additional considerations in determining the best qualified officers:

(1) **Competence.** In addition to proven and sustained superior performance in command or other leadership positions, competence also includes the following attributes:

(a) **Commitment to Operational Excellence.** Because Mission One for every officer is the operational readiness of our Navy, the best qualified officers will demonstrate an unrelenting commitment to operational excellence. This

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commitment will be evidenced by mastery of the skills critical to naval warfare. The Navy values service and superior performance on operational fleet and subordinate command staffs.

(b) Continual Performance Improvement. This attribute includes the ability to self-assess and self-correct, using a "Get Real, Get Better" mindset every day. It also includes the ability to develop a culture of learning in the teams they are called to lead, embracing meaningful feedback as an opportunity to get better.

(c) Education and Professional Development. Graduate-level education that develops naval warfare competencies and prepares officers to lead and think strategically is integral to developing warfighting advantage. Professional Military Education (PME), advanced degree programs, professional certifications, experiential learning, and other non-standard educational opportunities provide a rich portfolio for developing future leaders. The boards will actively seek those officers whose records reflect operational excellence and increasing education, and exposure to strategic concepts. Strategic competition demands leaders who possess the ability to outthink and outfight all competitors and adversaries.

1. In accordance with the Naval Education Strategy 2023 and Secretary of the Navy Memorandum "Continuous Learning for Naval Officers" dated August 26, 2021, the boards shall give favorable consideration to those officers with graduate education relevant to naval warfighting, experience in specialized areas, Navy PME and Joint PME (JPME). In May 2018, the Unrestricted Line (URL) instituted a board selection process for in-residence graduate education programs. That board selection process ensures that URL officers with superior performance records are afforded the opportunity for graduate education. Cultivation of our best and brightest officers through high quality in-residence, low-residence, and hybrid learning enhances critical thinking skills and warfighting expertise. Beginning with officers in year group 2015, graduate education will be required prior to assuming major command. In determining officers who are best and fully qualified for promotion, the board should give favorable consideration to officers who have obtained naval warfighting-relevant graduate education. Degrees earned through Department of the Navy funded Low-residency Graduate Education Program fulfill the graduate education requirement.

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2. The Navy values graduate education and development of a subspecialty. Degrees and certificates from the Naval Postgraduate School, the Naval War College or equivalent Service institutions, and civilian education programs that result in assignment of a subspecialty code or award of Additional Qualification Designation (AQD) codes are desirable. Proven expertise from an experience tour utilizing that subspecialty is both valued and fundamental to development of Navy leaders.

3. The Navy values competitive scholarships and fellowships, examples of which include: Olmsted Scholar, Marshall Scholar, Rhodes Scholar, White House Fellowship, Secretary of Defense Corporate Fellowship, Tours with Industry, Legislative Fellowships, and Federal Executive Fellowships (e.g., politico-military and cyber).

4. Best qualified officers seek opportunities to broaden their cultural awareness through experiences and education to enable better communication in a global operating environment.

5. The Navy values the importance of Naval Reserve Officers Training Corps (NROTC), Officer Training Command (OTC), Recruit Training Command (RTC), and U.S. Naval Academy (USNA) duties in building and developing future Navy leaders. When reviewing an officer's qualifications for the next higher grade, you should give favorable consideration to NROTC/OTC/RTC/USNA assignments.

6. Favorable consideration shall be given to the critical need for senior leaders who are Joint Qualified Officers as documented by an AQD.

(d) Individual Augmentee (IA)/Global Support Assignment (GSA)/Overseas Contingency Operations (OCO)/Irregular Warfare/Afghanistan-Pakistan Hands (APH) Program Assignment.

1. The boards may give favorable consideration to those officers who have displayed superior performance while serving in IA/GSA/OCO/APH assignments in direct support of OCO, Irregular Warfare, and the National Defense Strategy and, in particular, those IA/GSA/OCO/APH assignments that are extraordinarily arduous and/or involve significantly heightened personal risk. These individuals are developing valuable combat

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and nation-building skills under stressful conditions. Such assignments may not be typical of the officer's traditional community career path, and the officer may be rated by a reporting senior unfamiliar with the officer's specialty and the Navy fitness report system.

2. IA/GSA/OCO assignments may take an officer out of the normal community career path for periods up to one and a half years. APH assignments consist of extensive specialized training and multiple, non-standard deployments that may take an officer out of the normal community career path for periods of up to three and a half years.

(e) Ensures adherence to standards while fostering innovation. Every officer must build on an understanding of standards to think creatively, develop new ideas, take prudent risks, and deliver superior outcomes. Innovative officers, who can build great teams that innovate as they manage risk and ensure standards, may come from a variety of backgrounds.

(2) Character. In addition to competence, the best qualified officers will demonstrate the following attributes:

(a) Possesses and openly demonstrates the four core attributes. The challenges facing our Navy are growing in scope, scale, and pace. To meet these challenges, the Navy needs leaders who have demonstrated estimable character and are prepared for decentralized operations. You should give careful consideration to officers who demonstrate the four core attributes that guide our decisions and actions: integrity, accountability, initiative, and toughness. Integrity may be demonstrated as an individual or as a team member by displaying conduct that is upright, honorable, and by working to strengthen the resolve of their peers, superiors, and subordinates. Accountability may be demonstrated by achieving and maintaining high standards, honestly assessing progress, and adjusting as required. Officers demonstrate initiative by taking ownership, acting to the limit of their authorities, and looking at new ideas with an open mind. Toughness can mean marshalling all sources of strength and resilience, including rigorous training; encouraging the fighting spirit of our people; and providing steadfast support to our families. Officers who demonstrate these core attributes ensure the Navy remains the world's finest navy and deserve your careful consideration when selecting officers who are best and fully qualified.

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(b) Builds strong culture and teams while achieving measurable outcomes. You should give careful consideration to officers who demonstrate the following behaviors:

1. Relentlessly builds a culture of the highest character - a tough, resilient team that wins.

2. Acknowledges and honors the value of every Sailor and civilian.

3. Takes care of themselves and their teammates.

4. Fosters connectedness and cohesion at all levels and among individuals and teams.

5. Always does the right thing, especially when it is hard.

6. Keeps close watch on their own mental, physical, and emotional health, and the health of those they lead.

(c) Demonstrates a commitment to personal and professional growth. You should give careful consideration to officers who build on our Core Values of commitment in how they demonstrate a "Get Real, Get Better" mindset; use data-driven insights; master the skills critical to naval warfare; and act transparently in how they receive feedback from seniors, peers, and subordinates alike.

(d) Builds connectedness and cohesion. You should give careful consideration to officers who lead with humility and consistently and sustainably inspire their teams to perform at their best, creating teams that are connected and cohesive, regardless of background. This trait includes active listening to subordinates of all ranks and backgrounds and the ability to effectively self-assess.

(e) Is loyal to and behaves consistently with the Navy's Core Values. You should give careful consideration to officers who actively pursue what is right and behave consistently with the Navy's Core Values. While we do not embrace a zero-defect officer corps, the best qualified officers

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will demonstrate consistency between the Navy's Core Values and
their on- and off-duty behavior.

(3) **Championing a Culture of Excellence.** The boards
should give favorable consideration to those officers who are
deliberate in how they build great people, leaders, and teams.
This is demonstrated through emotional intelligence, self-
awareness, and investing in their people's needs.

(4) **COVID-19 Vaccine Refusal Adverse Information.**
Promotion selection boards will not consider any adverse
information related solely to COVID-19 vaccine refusal in cases
in which an accommodation was requested. Additionally, you
shall not consider any other adverse information related solely
to COVID-19 vaccine refusal. If adverse information related
solely to COVID-19 vaccine refusal is identified in eligible
officer's record, you will notify the board administrative
support staff.

(5) **Indo-Pacific Area Expertise Considerations**

(a) As indicated in the National Defense Strategy,
China is leveraging military modernization and predatory
economics to coerce neighboring countries to reorder the Indo-
Pacific region to their advantage. As the People's Republic of
China continues to seek economic and military dominance, it will
continue to pursue a military modernization program that tries
to displace the United States to achieve global preeminence in
the future.

(b) Recognizing this challenge to U.S. national
security interests, special consideration shall be given to
officers who have excelled in their knowledge of the political-
military affairs and U.S. strategic interests in the Indo-
Pacific region, and operational contingency planning for Indo-
Pacific war plans.

(6) **Joint Officer Considerations**

(a) Our ability to operate effectively with the
other Services is vital to our war-fighting capability. To
foster this ability, a number of officers are assigned to joint
duty with the Joint Staff, the other Services, and joint
organizations. To ensure our ability to conduct joint

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operations, the Navy is firmly committed to placing as many officers as possible in joint duty assignment billets.

(b) Success in these assignments should be given special consideration, and the statutory joint promotion objectives, delineated in enclosure (4), represent critical requirements that warrant particular consideration when determining which officers are best qualified for promotion. However, these statutory joint promotion objectives do not alter the best and fully qualified selection standard. As such, members shall only select eligible officers who are best and fully qualified for promotion, even if doing so will result in a failure to meet the statutory joint promotion objectives.

e. **Consideration of Reserve Officers.** Within the Reserve Component (RC), a variety of mission integration options are available to support the Navy with flexibility, speed, and agility. In addition to drill periods, operational requirements are met by periods of active-duty including mobilization, active-duty for operational support, and active-duty for training. Selected Reserve (SELRES) records may reflect a variation in duration of reporting periods as members execute a variety of orders - this should not be viewed negatively. In determining best and fully qualified, these time periods should be viewed in the context of a continuum of service, integral to delivering strategic depth.

f. **Training and Administration of the Reserve (TAR) Community Considerations.** TAR Officers perform a statutory role in "organizing, administering, recruiting, instructing, or training the reserve components" (section 12310 of title 10, U.S. Code), and favorable consideration should be given to those TAR officers who have displayed superior performance in critical staff, leadership, recruiting, and command tours - specifically, either operational and/or reserve management command tours. (Note: in addition to reserve centers, recruiting commands, readiness commands, and operational units such as reserve aviation squadrons, Maritime Expeditionary Security Squadrons (MSRONs), and reserve commands within Navy Special Warfare are Navy Reserve Activities and involve reserve management responsibilities at both the O-4 department head level and O-5/O-6 command level).

(1) **Dual career paths.** Many TAR officers, particularly in the URL and Human Resources (HR) communities, complete a

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balance of operational or community-specific milestone tours (e.g., commanding officer and major staff assignments, operational department head tours and operational aviation, special warfare and afloat command tours) and reserve management milestone tours (e.g., Navy Reserve Center (NRC) and Navy and/or Reserve Talent Acquisition Group (RTAG/NTAG) commanding officer, Navy Reserve major staff assignments). Officers selected must have demonstrated exceptional managerial skill and professional competence in operational, executive, and staff roles. In determining those officers best qualified for promotion, you should consider favorably those officers who have served in a broad spectrum of assignments requiring expertise in varied functional areas. Operational requirements can sometimes limit the reserve management assignments of some officers and this limitation should not disadvantage these officers (e.g., command at sea for Surface Warfare Officers). Success and sustained exceptional performance in these areas are the most important attributes for consideration.

(2) Subspecialty requirements. TAR officers with Financial Management (FM) expertise are required to manage Reserve Personnel Navy and Operation and Maintenance Navy Reserve accounts. Although these subspecialty qualifications are a core requirement for a portion of the TAR HR community, officers of any designator may possess them. Regardless of designator, these subspecialties are critical to the TAR community and should receive favorable consideration.

(3) Career backgrounds prior to selection as TAR Officers. Navy Reserve officers who have been recalled to active-duty will often have fewer active-duty fitness reports than their Active Component (AC) peers. Due consideration shall be given to the fitness reports available and the quality of performance reflected in the record. An officer's record shall not be discounted simply because it contains fewer active-duty fitness reports than a peer's record.

6. Equal Opportunity Guidance

a. The Department of the Navy is dedicated to equality of treatment and opportunity for all personnel without regard to race, religion, color, sex (including pregnancy), sexual orientation, or national origin. The Navy demands a professional working environment in which any of these bases will not limit a Sailor's professional opportunities.

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Discrimination on any of these bases is contrary to the Department's Core Values of honor, courage, and commitment. Accordingly, within this board's charter to determine the officers who are "best and fully qualified," or "fully qualified," as applicable, you must ensure that officers of every race, religion, color, sex (including pregnancy), sexual orientation, and national origin are given fair and equitable consideration.

b. Your evaluation of all officers must be fair and equitable. You should evaluate each officer's potential to assume the responsibilities of the next higher grade, with the overriding factor being performance of assigned duties.

c. Impermissible Considerations. Promotion boards are prohibited from considering the following:

(1) The marital status, civilian employment, religion, or volunteer service of an officer;

(2) Any information regarding an officer's spouse, including, but not limited to, civilian or military employment, education, race, religion, color, sex (including pregnancy), sexual orientation, national origin, and volunteer service;

(3) An officer's previous decision to opt out of a promotion selection board; and

(4) An officer's previous participation in the Career Intermission Program.

d. The Navy has assigned some officers outside of traditional career development patterns, including assignments to institutional instructor and recruiting billets. These assignments, though greatly beneficial to the Navy, may have foreclosed to the officers so assigned opportunities available to other officers. In addition, other utilization policies or practices, such as those based on statutory restrictions on the assignment of women, may have had an effect on career opportunities previously. Such assignment practices should not prejudice the selection of these men and women for promotion. Successful performance of duties assigned is the key in measuring an officer's potential for promotion; duty performed well by men and women affected by such utilization policies or

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practices should be given weight equal to duty performed well by
an officer not affected by such policies or practices.

e. This guidance shall not be interpreted as requiring or
permitting preferential treatment of any officer or group of
officers on the grounds of race, religion, color, sex (including
pregnancy), sexual orientation, or national origin.

7. Unrestricted Line (URL) Considerations

a. Reserve command at sea is most valued within the URL for
promotion to O-6. Reserve management is a critical component of
operational command functions and tasks. Separate and distinct
career paths among RC URL communities and individual career
timing result in officers serving in command at different points
in their careers. For example, some officers may be early in
command while others may have completed a command tour prior to
in-zone consideration for O-6. Board members should understand
these differences and not view them negatively. As always,
sustained superior performance at sea provides positive
indication of potential to serve in the next higher grade.

b. Aviation merit reorder slides guide the following
discussion: Naval Aviation is a large and competitive
community. Those officers who are consistently recognized as
Early Promote (EP) performers in competitive summary groups
during both sea and shore assignments should receive first
priority for merit reordering. Priority should be given to
officers who have earned a #1 EP FITREP in a competitive summary
group as a commanding officer of an Operational Aviation
Squadron, Squadron Augmentation Unit, or Navy Reserve Readiness
Unit. All communities value longer periods of recognized
performance as a commanding officer. Naval Aviation values
follow-on shore tours in nominative assignments and Naval
Aviation Enterprise (NAE)-valued community staff assignments
(N98, PERS-43, NAWDC, CNAF/CNAL EA). Priority should be given
to officers who earn an EP FITREP in one of these assignments.
Aviation Officers selected for a bonus command opportunity (FRS)
or major command (CVN nuclear power pipeline) should also be
prioritized. Finally, additional consideration should be given
to officers who have completed in-residence graduate education;
met the criteria as a Joint Qualified Officer; and/or officers
who have completed a tour in Financial Management or Operations
Analysis.

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c. Surface Warfare (TAR) merit reorder slides guide the following discussion: Surface Warfare is a large and competitive community. Those officers with breakout performance (EP hard break, #1 or #2 soft break, or above RSCA metrics where a soft break is not included) in command at sea, executive officer afloat, or an Operational Command should receive first priority for merit reordering. Additional considerations should be given to officers who are recognized top performers in O-5 Navy Reserve Center Command, and/or as Readiness and Mobilization Command (REDCOM) CSO. Additional consideration should also be given to officers with JPME Phase II and/or Joint Qualified Officer complete, and stand-out performance in significant reserve management (OSD, SECNAV, SURFLANT/SURFPAC RPD OPNAV, BUPERS, OCNR, CNRFC, NPC and/or requirements or financial management tours (e.g., OCNR N0958, N0959, OPNAV N80, N81, N82, N96, N95, N4).

d. Surface Warfare (SELRES) merit reorder slides guide the following discussion: Surface Warfare is a large and competitive community. Those officers with breakout performance (EP hard break, #1 or #2 soft break) in MSRON command at sea or APPLY Board selected reserve unit Command should receive first priority for merit reordering. Additional consideration should be given to officers with stand-out performance in one or more Surface Reserve community pillars: Naval Surface Force, Maritime Expeditionary Security Force, Operational Level of War, Military Sealift Command assignments or forward deployed mobilization assignments. Additional consideration should also be given to officers with an Advanced Degree, JPME Phase II, and/or demonstrated commitment to the community through leadership or participation in the Surface Warfare Reserve Enterprise or other projects supporting the Surface Force.

e. Submarine merit reorder slides guide the following discussion: Those officers recognized as top performers based on rankings while serving (or having served) as a CO should receive first priority for merit reordering. Additional consideration should be given to officers who have been consistently recognized as EP performers in competitive summary groups during assignments.

f. Reserve Component TAR Officer Naval Special Warfare merit reorder slides guide the following discussion: Those officers who are serving, or served as commanding officer, and were recognized as top performers in command as well as in all

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previous assignments should receive first priority for merit reorder. Additional consideration should be given to TAR officers who demonstrate superior performance on a Flag or Joint Staff, have completed JPME Phase II, or are designated as either Joint Qualified Officers (reflected by AQD JS5) or Acquisition Practitioners in Program Management (reflected AQD AA2).

(1) Reserve Component SELRES Officers should be given favorable consideration if recognized as top performers while serving as NRRU CO who are JPME Phase II/Master's/Joint Qualified Officer complete and have demonstrated superior performance and experience in two progressive NSW NRRU CO positions. Additional consideration should be given for active-duty service greater than six months in an NSW DEPORD requirement (NSW, TSOC, MOC/Fleet Integration). Officers who are consistently recognized as Early Promote (EP) performers, above RSCA, during both sea and shore assignments should receive first priority for merit reordering.

g. Reserve Component TAR Officer EOD merit reorder slides guide the following discussion: EOD TAR is a small community, and it is standard for officers to be ranked one of one on Fitness Reports. Priority should be given to officers who are consistently recognized as Early Promote performers regardless of summary group size or operational/reserve management assignment. Additional consideration should be given to officers who earned a competitive FITREP as a commanding officer with a 4-month reporting period. Favorable consideration should be given to top performing officers serving in major staff, Joint Staff, and screened/nominative assignments. Additional consideration should be given to officers who have completed JPME Phase II or are fully joint qualified.

(1) Reserve Component SELRES Officers should be given favorable consideration if they have been awarded EOD CO (AQD KG7) and/or demonstrated superior performance and experience in operational and screened 1145 and/or 1135 commanding officer positions (EXU, NECC, NSW, CCCR) and major staff assignments (COCOM, TSOC, NSWC, CNRFC, OPNAV, OCNR, OSD, JCS, BUPERS, NPC). Officers who are consistently recognized as Early Promote (EP) performers, above RSCA, during both sea and shore assignments should receive first priority for merit reordering. Additional consideration should be given to officers who have successfully completed JPME Phase II or AJPME.

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8. **Human Resources (HR) Community Considerations**

a. The HR community provides core human resource expertise to define, attract, recruit, develop, assign, and retain America's best talent. Career progression produces HR officers serving in critical roles in leadership and major staff positions. Successful HR officers demonstrate sustained superior performance in all assignments and with increasing responsibilities across three billet types: command and leadership, sea duty (AC only), and milestone tours.

(1) The HR 1205 community now includes Fleet N1/J1 manpower and requirements billets as milestone as these are critical warfighter enablement capabilities.

(2) Additionally, successful 1205 HR officers will distinguish themselves through service within the 1205 community in roles including mentorship, Executive Steering Committee (ESC) involvement, HR regional positions, and Direct Commission Officer Interviewer or board support. Such service is valued for both promotion and merit reorder consideration at all paygrades.

b. Community Values are listed in order of significance for each paygrade.

c. Officers who have sustained superior performance in assigned duties and an increasing scope of responsibilities in command, leadership, major staff (e.g., SECNAV, OPNAV, OCNR, CNRFC, NPC), and/or milestone, indicate potential to succeed at the level of Captain. Officers currently serving in a second command, leadership, or milestone tour in a given paygrade should not be looked upon negatively if their tour is not complete.

d. Prior to the rank of captain, the following are valued achievements for 1205 officers (in priority order):

(1) Successful leadership in or completion of commander command/milestone assignments and demonstrated Reserve leadership.

(2) Periods of active-duty such as mobilization, ADOS or recall in N1 enterprises throughout the fleet.

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(3) Master's degree in subspecialties including
Financial Management, Manpower Systems Analysis, Education and
Training Management, Operations Analysis, Information Systems
and Technology (3XXX SSP preferred).

(4) Attainment of command qualification and screening
(2N1 AQD).

(5) Professional certification including PHR, SPHR,
GPHR, CPT, CPLP, CDFM, CDFM-A, CISSP or GSLC.

(6) JPME Phase I completed.

e. For 1207 (HR TAR) significant core competency area (CCA)
depth with CCA breadth in reserve management billets and the
successful completion of command, as documented by AQD (e.g.,
CE3, CE4, CE5, etc.) indicates potential to succeed at the level
of captain.

Note: Career Tracks are only applicable to AC 1200 HR officers.

f. Officers who have proven HR-focused subspecialties
(including Operations Research Analysis, Manpower Systems
Analysis, Financial Management, and Education and Training
Management, or civilian equivalent (plus IT (TAR only))),
indicate proven application of human capital theories, concepts,
and analysis and are valued by the HR community.

g. Officers who maintain a current industry-recognized HR-
related certification (or IT certification (TAR only)) have
demonstrated the ability to understand and apply human capital
theories, concepts, and laws/regulations critical to policy
development and execution across the Navy.

h. For merit reorder considerations, valued achievements
prior to captain for SELRES HR officers are as follows:

(1) Recognized top performer across all assignments,
especially in commander HR command/milestone assignments,
leadership tours, or periods of active-duty such as
mobilization, ADOS, or recall in N1 enterprises throughout the
fleet.

(2) Master's degree in subspecialties including
Financial Management, Manpower Systems Analysis, Education and

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Training Management, Operations Analysis, and Information
Systems and Technology (3XXX SSP preferred).

(3) Professional certifications in disciplines to
include: PHR, SPHR, GPHR, CDFM, CDFM-A, CISSP, or GSLC.

(4) Attainment of command qualification (2N1 AQD).

(5) JPME Phase I and II completed.

i. For merit reorder considerations, valued achievements
prior to captain for TAR HR officers:

(1) Recognized top performer across all assignments,
especially NRC/NRPDC CO, RTAG/NTAG CO, Milestone and Major
Reserve Staff and reserve management billets.

(2) Subspecialty experience, with at least two proven
subspecialties (Q/R suffix): (311X, 3130, 3150, 321X, 620X,
6511).

(3) At least one master's degree in subspecialties
including Financial Management, Manpower Systems Analysis,
Education and Training Management, Operations Analysis, and
Information Systems and Technology (3XXX SSP preferred).

(4) Professional certifications in disciplines to
include: PHR, SPHR, GPHR, CDFM, CDFM-A, CISSP, GSLC.

(5) Successful completion of command at sea or ashore,
as documented by AQD (e.g., CE3, CE4, CE5, etc.).

9. **Engineering Duty Officer (EDO) Community Considerations**

a. Officers with sustained superior performance and
leadership at the commanding officer/executive officer/officer-
in-charge level should be given favorable consideration. Proven
experience across critical competency skills and mastery of
PQS/ITP qualifications should be secondary considerations.

b. SELRES Officers typically are not assigned to
acquisition billets, their roles are focused on warfighting
readiness, technical expertise and mission execution. A lack of
specific DAWIA qualifications among SELRES should not be viewed
negatively.

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10. Aerospace Engineering Duty Officer (AEDO) (Engineering and Maintenance) Community Considerations

a. Board members should examine an officer's ability to lead large, complex organizations or programs and the ability to work collaboratively across organizations, services, and departments to initiate and sustain effective team performance. Superior leadership is the most important trait for selected individuals. Consideration should be given to those officers that have demonstrated superior performance while mobilized, or on active-duty for operational support (ADOS) in support of the Naval Aviation Enterprise.

b. For merit reorder consideration, clear recommendations toward early promotion should accompany recognized sustained superior performance as a top performing commanding officer of a NAVAIR O-5 command or executive officer of a NAVAIR O-6 command. Officers should excel in billets of increasing complexity, responsibility, and scope.

c. Engineering (1515) officers under consideration for promotion to captain should demonstrate superior performance in O-5 leadership positions such as a commanding officer of a NAVAIR unit, executive officers of NAVAIR Reserve Program, IPT leads, and Deputy Chiefs of Staff should also be given consideration. Acquisition experience is essential; DAWIA legacy Level II or Practitioner/Advanced certification in Engineering or Engineering Technical Management practitioner is highly valued; and additional DAWIA legacy Level II or practitioner certification in Program Management is desired.

d. Maintenance (1525) officers under consideration for promotion to captain should demonstrate superior performance in O-5 leadership positions such as commanding officer of a NAVAIR unit, executive officer of a NAVAIR Reserve Program O-6 command, mission/executive officer of a NAVAIR O-6 command, IPT lead, and deputy chief of staff should also be given consideration. Acquisition experience is essential; DAWIA legacy Level I certification in Production, Quality, Manufacturing, or foundational certification in Life Cycle Logistics is highly valued; and additional DAWIA legacy Level II or practitioner certification in Program Management is desired.

e. Maintenance (1527) officers under consideration for promotion to captain should demonstrate superior performance in

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O-5 leadership positions such as officer in charge or Wing Maintenance Officer, and major staff. Navy Reserve Center commanding officers should also be given consideration. Acquisition experience is essential.

11. Public Affairs Officer (PAO) Community Considerations

a. PAOs use communication skills, strategies, and tactics to support a commander's objectives. Career progression produces senior PAOs who can lead an organization's communication enterprise and demonstrate an awareness and ability to navigate the dynamics of the information environment to achieve desired communication end states. Successful senior PAOs communicate strategically, demonstrate critical thinking, conduct thorough problem set analysis, execute tactically, and provide astute counsel to flag officers and staffs. Providing direct support to flag and general officers is the pinnacle of a PAO's career. As such, sustained superior performance in varied billets, particularly direct senior leader support on operational staffs, community leadership, Washington, D.C. headquarters, and joint staffs indicate strong potential for future success. Keep in mind an officer's career track may not include all desired career markers due to the Reserve slating process, which influences an officer's billet assignment process, but does not allow for detailing an officer into a billet. Senior reserve PAOs must demonstrate excellent management and administrative skills to ensure RC officers and Sailors under their charge are mobilization and warfighting ready for short-fused contingency, high-visibility priority or crisis missions afloat or ashore. As such, sustained superior performance in public affairs leadership billets, particularly on numbered fleets and operational staffs, as well as in combat operations with demonstrated mastery of the full range of public affairs skills as it applies to maritime operations and warfighting indicates strong potential for future success.

b. Fully qualified PAOs should have:

(1) Successfully completed and have demonstrated superior performance in a commander milestone tour (Numbered Fleet, Ech II executive officer, IA), as demonstrated by earning the 7M2 AQD, or through documented superior performance over 18 months in a community designated priority billet providing strategic-level counsel role to flag or general officers, keeping in mind that an officer's career track might not include

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a commander milestone tour due to the recent establishment of
milestone billets.

(2) A record of sustained superior performance as a
commanding officer/officer-in-charge and/or executive
officer/assistant officer-in-charge, particularly of
operational, Numbered Fleet, fleet commander, and large public
affairs SELRES units, with experience supporting afloat and
operational missions to achieve the command's objectives
indicates potential to succeed as a captain. Achieving the Navy
Reserve Augment Unit commanding officer/officer-in-charge
additional qualification designator, (2N1 AQD) is required for
promotion.

(3) Sustained superior performance providing strategic-
level counsel to Flag and General officers on a major staff such
as USFFC/PACFLT/NAVEUR, Numbered Fleet, and/or at Joint or
CCMDs.

(4) PAOs who have demonstrated experience as the senior
public affairs SME during fleet operations and/or fleet
exercises should be given favorable consideration.

(5) Demonstrated success of leadership contributions to
community management initiatives/collateral duty assignments.

c. Best qualified PAOs should have (in priority order):

(1) Superior performance in their assigned duties in
operational or fleet tours, and senior advisor roles, which is
more important than earning degrees, accreditations and
certifications.

(2) A successful track record of translating commander's
vision and intent into public communication strategies and
plans; leading, advising, and aligning active-reserve integrated
enterprise Public Affairs personnel and programs, particularly
in operational settings and, leading the execution of Navy
public communication efforts across multiple and varied
organizations, in order to achieve strategic and operational
goals.

(3) Demonstrated superior performance, particularly in
an O-5 public affairs leadership role, during
crisis/combat/contingency operations, an individual augmentee

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assignment, with extra weight placed on successful OCONUS
deployments or mobilizations.

(4) Additional consideration should be given to officers
who have demonstrated experience and leadership of PA
capabilities in Maritime Operations (MOC), Operational Level of
War (OLW), and/or Operations in the Information Environment
(OIE).

d. Values for Merit Reorder in order of priority:

(1) Officers selected for merit reorder should stand out
among those selected for promotion as the best of the group.

(2) Sustained superior performance throughout their time
in grade, with particular scrutiny of their performance in
leadership, milestone, and community designated priority
billets.

12. Strategic Sealift Officer (SSO) Community Considerations

a. The SSO Force (SSOF) provides qualified Navy Reserve
Officers with civilian credentials and military training to
support the activation, operation, and sustainment of the United
States organic Strategic Sealift Fleet and in support to
Maritime Domain Operations, and the Maritime Industrial Base
throughout the continuum of conflict.

b. Unique to the SSOF:

(1) Promotes both IRR (~90%) and SELRES (~10%) career
paths together- two separate but equal tracks.

(2) SSO IRR is the only designator requiring NOB FITREPS
for 12-day ADTs.

(3) IRR do not require FITREP continuity. IRR minimum
annual participation requirement is 12-day ADT.

(4) SSOF Command and Control (C2) structure is in place
to enable IRR mobilization for warfighting readiness, while
providing Group Commander and officer in charge leadership level
roles.

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c. Fully qualified:

(1) Earned warfare qualification listed in the Officer
Summary Record (OSR) as: SSO WARFARE.

(2) Have a United States Coast Guard (USCG) Merchant
Mariner Credential (MMC) documented as AQDs in the OSR as a
special qualification. MMCs approved by the USCG, but not
issued, are considered valid with documentation from the USCG.

d. Best qualified:

(1) Maintain proficiency at sea with meaningful underway
experience within the last four years and demonstrate sustained
superior performance in reserve leadership positions and
maritime related active-duty assignments.

(2) Attainment or maintenance of an advanced MMC
demonstrates operational and leadership ability as a
professional mariner indicating greater potential to succeed in
all phases of ship operations. MMCs and their corresponding AQD
short titles are identified below:

(a) Commanding officer equivalent: Master (MASTER)
or Chief Engineer (STM CHENG, MTR CHENG, GT CHENG); (Most valued
level).

(b) Executive officer equivalent: Chief Mate (DO CH
MATE) or First Assistant Engineer (STM 1ST ASST, MTR 1ST ASST,
GT 1ST ASST).

(c) Department head equivalent: Second Mate (DO
SECMATE) or Second Assistant Engineer (STM 2ND ASST, MTR 2ND
ASST, GT 2ND ASST).

(d) Division officer equivalent: Third Mate (DO
THRDMATE) or Third Assistant Engineer (STM 3RD ASST, MTR 3RD
ASST, GT 3RD ASST).

e. Favorable consideration:

(1) Demonstrate leadership during challenging
mobilization, Active-Duty for Operational Support (ADOS),
recall, or extended Active-Duty for Training (ADT) assignments.

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(2) Tactical Advisor (TACAD) qualification (AQD TC1) and
have served as a TACAD afloat, (AQD TC2/3) on multiple
occasions.

(3) Complete advanced or joint military education.

(4) Demonstrate civilian maritime leadership
experience/subject matter expertise or are engaged in long-term
support of SSOF community management.

(5) SELRES with valid STCW endorsement.

f. Considerations for Merit Reorder: Ideally, candidates
for merit reorder should meet all criteria. Values for merit
reorder are listed on the merit reorder slide. SSOs who have
sustained superior performance that result in tangible
improvements to the SSOF that surpass those of their peers are
heavily weighted.

g. Commanders who have had a successful track record of
sustained superior performance and demonstrated expertise in
demanding billets and assignments provided valued reserve
contributions to Navy mission via operational/mobilization
assignments.

(1) IRR commanders who are best and fully qualified for
promotion to captain have attained or maintained one of the
following USCG MMCs: MASTER, STM CHENG, MTR CHENG, or GT CHENG,
and consistently executed annual ADT.

(2) SELRES commanders who have demonstrated superior
performance, successfully served in challenging billets and
leadership tours across a variety of commands such as commanding
officer, officer-in-charge, executive officer, and/or chief
staff officer should receive favorable consideration.

(3) Significant community leadership in the SSOF C2
structure.

(4) Major staff or joint experience.

(5) The community values commanders who consistently
demonstrated leadership in engineering or port operations
planning, maintenance, or repair activities, both shore-side and

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afloat and whose annual training efforts align with Port
Engineer, Life Cycle Management, Navy Operational Planning or
Safety Management System functions.

(6) Values for Merit Reorder (in order of priority):

(a) IRR with MASTER, MASTER with PILOT endorsement,
STM CHENG, MTR CHENG, or GT CHENG USCG MMCs.

(b) SELRES demonstrating superior performance in
their assigned duties while serving as commanding officer or
officer-in-charge.

(c) Superior performance in their assigned duties
in operational, fleet or staff tours should be weighted more
heavily than earning degrees, accreditations, and
certifications.

(d) Significant community leadership in the SSOF
Command and Control Structure as Group Commander or in the SSOF
Instructor Cadre as course director should be given favorable
consideration. These leadership roles are key for SSO outreach
and warfighter readiness.

(e) Completed JPME Phase I.

(f) Completed relevant post-graduate degree.

13. Foreign Area Officer (FAO) Community Considerations

a. FAOs are the Navy's globally embedded, persistently
forward, strategic operators. Career progression produces
officers who deliver assured global access and posture,
interoperability with U.S. partners, and human information
advantage for the fleet. Successful FAOs demonstrate sustained
superior performance and increasing responsibilities along three
billet types: Embassy Security Cooperation Officer; Defense
Attaché Service (Senior Defense Official/Defense Attaché (DATT)
or Naval Attaché (NATT)); and Strategy, Plans, and Policy (Navy,
Joint, or Inter-Agency staffs). The SDO/DATT serves as both the
senior attaché and the senior Security Cooperation Officer.

b. Fully qualified FAOs receive the "FAO Q" AQD. This AQD
requires: a political-military master's degree or equivalent;

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documented language proficiency at a level of 2 or higher in two of three modalities (listening, reading, speaking); and no less than six months of in-region experience. FAOs working toward full qualification hold the "FAO T" AQD.

c. Non-observed time for language study, master's-level education, and billet specific training is expected and should not be viewed negatively.

d. For merit reorder consideration, superior performance in arduous overseas assignment(s) typified by one or more of the following: duty in remote, austere, and challenging locations, typically with unstable governments, authoritarian or non-permissive regimes, or significant environmental hazards. Reserve Component FAOs serving on temporary periods of active-duty and considered for O-6 selection shall be considered for merit reorder under the same conditions.

e. For promotion to Captain, FM2 (milestone complete) is a key attribute in determining the best qualified officers; but non-milestone officers with sustained superior performance in demanding roles may be best qualified for promotion if they excelled in delivering strategic-to-tactical outcomes at Embassy or fleet billets in areas of conflict or intense friction (e.g., wartime Ukraine or Israel, FIFTH Fleet, SEVENTH Fleet afloat). The bar to promotion for a non-milestone complete officer should be high.

f. Fully qualified officers have completed at least four years of commissioned service on active-duty at any paygrade (O-1 to O-5), which may include prior active service, active-duty operational support (ADOS), Recall, or mobilization orders. Fully qualified officers have earned a 'FAO Q' regional qualification AQD; completed Joint Foreign Area Officer Phase II (JFAO Phase II); and have completed JPME Phase I.

g. The RC FAO community also values (in order):

(1) Completion of the 2N1 AQD and successful performance in a reserve augment unit leadership assignment, commanding officer, executive officer, or officer-in-charge.

(2) Completion of advanced joint, strategic and operational courses including, but not limited to: Joint

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Qualified Officer (Level 3); "MOPC" AQD, "MSOC" AQD, "STAFF
MRITIM" AQD, or "JCWS" Service School.

(3) Fellowship, scholarship, or continued education
focused on Pol-Mil, strategy, or integrated multi-domain
warfighting planning.

14. **Information Warfare (IW) Line Considerations**

a. The IW Line is comprised of officers in the Oceanography (180X), Cryptologic Warfare (181X), Information Professionals (182X), Naval Intelligence (183X), Maritime Space Officer (187X), and Maritime Cyber Warfare Officer (188X) communities. The IW Line was created to more effectively and collaboratively lead and manage the officers who possess extensive skills in information-intensive specialties. The IW community aspires to assure command and control, generate predictive battle space awareness, and deliver integrated non-kinetic and kinetic fires, including effective maneuver across cyberspace, the electromagnetic spectrum, and space as a warfighting capability, within fleet and joint force.

b. The Navy needs officers who possess unimpeachable credentials, have deep technical/operational experience in the IW domain, are innovative and bold, think creatively and challenge assumptions, and take well-calculated risks to deliver outcomes. As such, board members should view an officer's performance in leadership assignments as an indicator of their ability to lead organizations across the broad range of IW missions and functions. Best qualified candidates will be top performers and will have experience leading, planning, synchronizing, aligning, integrating and executing operations across a range of IW disciplines.

c. As of May 31, 2013, all officers in competitive categories that compose the IW Line began receiving rankings within combined IW officer summary groups in block 42 of fitness reports. However, officers in competitive categories that comprise the IW Line compete for promotion within their respective individual officer designator category IAW SECNAVINST 14001B. As such, past summary group ranking may not fully show an officer's ranking relative to individual officer designator peers in their competitive category.

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d. Merit reorder consideration will be given to those IW officers with sustained superior performance, demonstrating exceptional proficiency within their specific IW designator and across multiple IW disciplines afloat and ashore. Officers considered for merit reorder will possess an outstanding record when ranked against their peers, within key operational milestone and leadership positions, and continued advancement of qualifications and higher education. Each IW designator's specific merit reorder consideration criteria is provided in amplified merit reorder consideration slides and will be followed.

15. Oceanography (OCEANO) Community Considerations

a. The OCEANO community's core mission capability and capacity draws on experience and expertise in the fields of meteorology, oceanography, precise time and astrometry, bathymetry, geophysics, and hydrography, and is focused on providing timely and relevant support to fleet and joint operations. OCEANO officers typically develop foundational expertise in assignments at operational meteorology and oceanography (METOC) commands.

b. Demonstrated expertise in one or more of the core missions of meteorology, oceanography, precise time and astrometry, bathymetry, geophysics, and hydrography is the foundation of the OCEANO community. Expertise in multiple warfighting areas is highly valued. OCEANO officers should have balanced professional experience, to include demonstrated leadership, operational proficiency and qualifications, and technical expertise. Proven and sustained superior performance in documented positions of leadership and in difficult, challenging, and arduous operational assignments is the ultimate test of readiness for promotion selection.

c. Education is valuable and highly regarded for OCEANO officers. All active-duty officers will participate in advanced education leading to a master's of science degree in Meteorology and/or Physical Oceanography. Reserve officers who have equivalent advanced education are highly valued.

d. Officers in the OCEANO community are eligible for, and generally granted, a scientific waiver for the Joint Qualified Officer designation requirement for flag officer promotion. However, JPME and joint experience are highly valued.

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e. Fully qualified reserve OCEANO captains will:

(1) Be currently assigned or have completed an APPLY-
selected reserve unit commanding officer or other
headquarters/major fleet staff oceanographer APPLY assignment.

(2) Have completed an advanced degree (master's or
doctorate).

f. Best qualified criteria is not a checklist, but rather a
list of valued skills and achievements beyond the fully
qualified criteria listed above that are indicative of officers
prepared for selection to the next higher paygrade. The best
qualified reserve OCEANO captains will have:

(1) Demonstrated superior leadership and performance in
APPLY-selected O-5 command.

(2) Demonstrated superior leadership and performance in
APPLY-selected oceanography assignments to major staffs such as
combatant commands, Numbered Fleet, Commander, Naval Meteorology
and Oceanography Command, or TYCOMs.

(3) Successfully completed or be in an OCEANO
mobilization or active-duty OCEANO operational tour at any rank.

(4) Completed technical post-graduate education in a
related field of study (oceanography, meteorology, or
hydrograph).

(5) Completed JPME Phase I.

16. Cryptologic Warfare (CW) Community Considerations

a. Leadership and demonstrated excellence in the CW core
mission areas of signals intelligence (SIGINT) and
electromagnetic warfare (EMW) are the foundation for successful
CW officers. The CW community values officers with deep
expertise in the information warfare domain (specifically
electromagnetic spectrum, space, and cyberspace) and a proven
record in cryptologic tours afloat and ashore. Future CW
leaders embrace a range of assignments in support of Naval and
joint operations and have experience across the breadth of CW
mission areas to include space or acquisition qualifications.
With the establishment of the Maritime Cyber Warfare Officer

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(MCWO)/188X community, most CW cyberspace planning and effects billets and functionalities within the Cyber Mission Force (CMF) and US Cyber Command (USCC) will transition to the MCWO community by the end of FY-26. However, CW Officers will continue to support cyberspace operations across the information warfare domain.

b. CW officers typically develop deep foundational SIGINT and cyber expertise in assignments at Navy Information Operations Commands (NIOC) and staffs aligned with NSA/CSS Cryptologic Centers, and CMF. CW officers gain SIGINT and EW expertise in embedded maritime and expeditionary environments, assigned to surface combatants as ship's company or afloat staff, NAVSPECWAR commands/units, as a Direct Support Officer (aboard surface, subsurface, or airborne platforms), or as a mobilized individual augmentee (service, national, or joint). Experience in SIGINT is denoted by the BI-series AQDs, while EMW experience is reflected through the BL-series AQDs. CW officers gain cyber expertise under the operational control of USCC, its naval component command, U.S. Fleet Cyber Command (FLTCYBERCOM), NSA, and joint arena (Joint Forces Headquarters/geographic combatant commands). These commands integrate tactically and operationally with fleet and joint forces in planning and executing operations worldwide. Cyber experience is documented through the BO-series AQDs. Additionally, CW officers make up a significant portion of the Navy's Space Cadre (VS-series AQDs) and can qualify for the Navy's Acquisition Corps (Acquisition series AQDs). The CW community values officers with experience in Space and Acquisition.

c. Fully qualified reserve CW captains will:

(1) Be currently assigned to or have completed an APPLY selected leadership tour (O-5 IWC unit commanding officer, major command executive officer as an O-5).

(2) Have completed an advanced degree (master's or doctorate).

d. Best qualified criteria is not a checklist, but rather a list of valued skills and achievements beyond the fully qualified criteria listed above that are indicative of officers prepared for selection to the next higher paygrade. The best qualified reserve CW captains will have:

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(1) Demonstrated superior performance and leadership as
an O-5 commanding officer or O-5 major command executive
officer.

(2) Demonstrated proficiency across more than one CW
mission area.

(3) Completed major staff tours (NAVIFORES HQ/REDCEN,
FCC/C10FLT, NSA, Joint).

(4) Successfully completed or be in a Cryptology
mobilization or active-duty operational tour at any rank.

(5) Have an advanced degree (master's or doctorate) in a
STEM-related field.

(6) Documented expertise in space (Space series AQD).

(7) Demonstrated Integrated Fires, Targeting, and/or
Operational Level of War AQD(s).

(8) Completed JPME Phase I.

17. **Information Professional (IP) Community Considerations**

a. Leadership and demonstrated excellence in C4 and cyber
in the maritime environment is the cornerstone of success for IP
officers. Future leaders of the IP community must have a proven
record at sea, in shore C4 and cyber tours, and demonstrated
technical IP expertise supporting Naval and joint operations.

b. The IP community gains a significant number of officers
through lateral transfer or redesignation, typically at O-3 and
O-4. For promotion eligibility purposes, these officers will
not have completed the IP qualifications or assignments. As
such, the board is encouraged to evaluate an officer's
demonstrated sustained superior performance in warfare-
appropriate billets (e.g., department head tours) and technical
acumen to identify this aspect of a fully qualified officer.

c. Fully qualified IP captains will:

(1) Be in or have completed an APPLY-selected O-5
commanding officer, program manager, CIO, or equivalent
assignment.

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(2) Have completed an advanced degree (master's or
doctorate).

d. Best qualified criteria is not a checklist, but rather a
list of valued skills and achievements beyond the fully
qualified criteria listed above that are indicative of officers
prepared for selection to the next higher paygrade. The best
qualified IP captains will have:

(1) Demonstrated superior performance in O-5 command or
executive officer billets.

(2) Attained Space AQD VS5 or higher; this is especially
valued when combined with relevant billet experience.

(3) Successfully completed or be in a mobilization or
active-duty operational tour at any rank.

(4) An advanced degree (master's or doctorate) in a
STEM-related field, advanced technical certifications, or DoD
CIO certificate.

(5) Completed JPME Phase I.

18. Intelligence (Intel) Community Considerations

a. Leadership, warfighting competence, and sustained
superior performance are the hallmarks of a successful Naval
Intelligence Officer. Senior Intel officers must possess a
well-rounded career that demonstrates proven leadership in
operationally-challenging environments, Navy and joint
operational warfighting proficiency and expertise in conducting
all-source operational intelligence (OPINTEL). Intel officers
are experts on the adversary and threats; therefore, developing
deep expertise on our nation's strategic competitors is
imperative. The Intel community also values additional
specialty skills, which are documented in records as Intel-
specific AQDs (typically 3XX alpha-numeric AQD series). All
officers should demonstrate progress toward completion of
advanced education.

b. Reserve intel competencies that contribute to Navy and
joint warfighting advantage include: OPINTEL, HUMINT (e.g.,
attaché, debriefing), SIGINT/Cyber, Technical Intel (e.g.,
foreign materiel exploitation), NSW Intel, Collection

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Management, Space, Targeting, and Expertise on Adversaries
(particularly PRC). Proficiency may be gained through unit
tours, schools, mobilizations, and orders.

c. The Intel community gains a significant number of
officers through lateral transfer or redesignation, typically at
O-3 and below. Some officers will have a mix of assignments in
both the Intel community and another Navy community (e.g.,
aviation, surface warfare, etc.) prior to redesignation into the
Intel community. All are equally valuable and board members are
encouraged to examine an officer's entire record to assess
career potential, leadership, and warfighting ability.

d. Fully qualified reserve Intel captains will:

(1) Be in or have completed an APPLY-selected O-5
leadership billet: Unit commanding officer/officer-in-
charge/executive officer and/or CNIFR HQ or REDCEN/Ech IV staff
billet.

(2) Have completed an advanced degree (master's or
doctorate).

(3) Have completed JPME Phase I.

e. Best qualified criteria is not a checklist, but rather a
list of valued skills and achievements beyond the fully
qualified criteria listed above that are indicative of officers
prepared for selection to the next higher paygrade. The best
qualified reserve Intel captains will:

(1) Have superior successful performance in more than
one O-5 leadership billet: unit commanding officer/officer-in-
charge/executive officer, CNIFR HQ, or REDCEN/Ech IV staff
billet.

(2) Be in or have successfully completed an Intel
mobilization or active-duty operational tour at any rank.

(3) Demonstrate leadership in more than one competency.

(4) Demonstrate superior leadership in both Navy and
joint units.

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(5) Progress toward designation as a Joint Qualified
Officer beyond JPME Phase I.

19. **Maritime Space Officer (MSO) Community Considerations**

a. Leadership and demonstrated excellence in the space domain is the cornerstone of success for MSO officers. Future leaders of the MSO community must have a documented record of outstanding performance in sea and shore tours with emphasis on technical expertise and operational experience in the space domain, integrating Naval, Joint and national space capabilities into maritime operations, or supporting fleet and joint commanders. MSOs should be well versed in technical capabilities, authorities for using space capabilities, adversary space capabilities, and Joint and Naval warfighting doctrine and operational concepts.

b. The MSO community has very limited commanding officer and executive officer opportunities for its officers. While experience in these positions is highly valued, officers who have not completed a commanding officer or executive officer tour should not be viewed negatively due to insufficient opportunities within the MSO community.

c. The MSO community gains a significant number of officers through lateral transfer or redesignation, typically at the O-3 to O-6 level. Some officers will have a mix of assignments in both the MSO community and another Navy community (e.g., another IW community or URL community) prior to redesignation into the MSO community. Both are equally valuable and board members are encouraged to examine an officer's entire record to assess career potential, leadership, and warfighting ability.

d. Fully qualified MSO captains will:

(1) Have successfully completed or be currently performing in a Space unit executive officer or MOC Space Cell officer-in-charge tour or equivalent MSO assignment.

(2) Be warfare qualified in any warfare area.

(3) Have completed JPME Phase I.

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e. Best qualified criteria is not a checklist, but rather a list of valued skills and achievements beyond the fully qualified criteria listed above that are indicative of officers prepared for selection to the next higher paygrade. The best qualified MSO captains will have:

(1) Demonstrated superior leadership and performance as an executive officer or MOC Space Cell officer-in-charge.

(2) Documented expertise in space (Space series AQD).

(3) Completed an advanced degree, preferably in technical or national security-related field of study.

(4) Completed JPME Phase II.

(5) Qualified as an IW Officer (IWO) under the IWO Qualification Program.

(6) Be in or successfully completed an MSO mobilization or active-duty operational tour at any rank.

20. **Reserve Limited Duty Officer (LDO) Considerations.**

Selection within the aggregate (LDO Line) continues for the reserve component. Consideration for promotion remains fully qualified officers who have demonstrated outstanding leadership and professional acumen commensurate with the opportunities provided in their designator career path. Best qualified officers will have completed command qualification, will be top performers, and will have consistently excelled at leading in operationally challenging environments and staff assignments throughout their career. Refer to the SECNAV-approved Community Value Slides for amplifying information on specific valued achievements for each control grade within the competitive categories.

21. **Recommendation for Reorder of Officers of Particular Merit**

a. After the boards have determined all best and fully qualified officers who should be recommended for promotion, it shall proceed to determine whether any of the recommended officers are of particular merit to be placed higher on the promotion list than their lineal number would place them. The officers recommended for merit-based reordering are, in the opinion of the majority of the members of the board, to be

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placed higher on the promotion list and in the order
recommended; or, no officers are recommended for merit-based
reordering, in the opinion of the majority of the members of the
board.

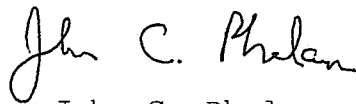
b. A number not to exceed 15 percent of the total
selections authorized for each grade and competitive category
may be placed higher on the promotion list unless the number
calculated is less than one, in which case the number that may
be placed higher on the promotion list is one. The boards may
determine that no officers should be placed higher on the
promotion list than their lineal number would place them.

c. Officers of particular merit are those officers whose
records contain documented performance consistently superior to
the performance of other officers recommended for promotion by
these boards.

d. No officer recommended for promotion shall be moved down
on the promotion list except by insertion of the name of an
officer of particular merit above that officer's name.

e. If the boards recommend officers of particular merit be
placed higher on the promotion list, then the boards shall
recommend the order in which those officers should be placed on
the list.

22. The Official Navy Record Markup Program (ONRMP) will be
utilized to "pre-markup" records with fitness report trend
lines, individual trait averages above reporting senior
cumulative average, rank changes, and tour lines. The board
member assigned is responsible to ensure ONRMP's accuracy during
record review.



John C. Phelan

Statutory and Regulatory Promotion Objectives

PROMOTION SELECTION [BOARD OR BOARDS]

(These objectives DO NOT alter the best and fully qualified selection standard discussed in the convening order.)

1. Statutory Joint Objectives. For officers assigned to joint duty within the best and fully qualified standard, the board shall strive to ensure that the following statutory promotion objectives are achieved:

a. Officers who are serving, or have served, on the Joint Staff (JS) are expected, as a group, to be promoted to the next higher grade at a rate not less than the rate for officers in the same grade and competitive category who are serving on, or have served on, Navy Headquarters staff; and

JS Rate $\geq$ HQ Rate of Selection

b. Officers in the grades of lieutenant commander or above who have been designated as a Joint Qualified Officer (JQO) are expected, as a group, to be promoted to the next higher grade at a rate not less than the rate for all officers in the same grade and competitive category.

JQO Rate $\geq$ Overall Selection Rate for Category

2. Statutory Acquisition Workforce Objective. In accordance with 10 U.S.C. § 1731, Acquisition Workforce (AW) officers are expected, as a group, to be promoted at a rate not less than the rate for all line (or the equivalent) officers (both in-zone and below-zone) in the same grade.

AW Rate $\geq$ All Line (or Equivalent) Rate (IZ & BZ)

3. Regulatory Objective. Although not contained in statute, the Secretary of Defense has established an additional promotion objective as a matter of policy. Officers who are serving, or have served since their last promotion board, on the staff of the Secretary of Defense are expected, as a group, to be promoted to the next higher grade at a rate not less than the rate for all officers in the same grade and competitive category who are serving, or who have served since their last promotion board, on the Navy Headquarters staff.

OSD Rate $\geq$ HQ Rate of Selection

4. Prior to adjournment, the board must review the extent to which the statutory and regulatory promotion objectives have been met.